



601 Mailability

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1.0 General Standards

1.1 Determining Mail-Processing Categories

1.1.1 Processing Categories

There are four mail-processing categories for mailpieces: letter, flat, machinable parcel, and nonstandard parcel. USPS assigns each mailpiece to one of these categories based on the physical dimensions and characteristics of the mailpiece using the longest dimension as the length, regardless of the placement or orientation of the delivery address on the piece. See the physical standards for processing categories in [101](#) for retail (single-piece price) mail and [201](#) for Commercial Mail.

1.1.2 Determining Length and Height

Determine the processing category (see [1.1.1](#)) based on the physical dimensions and characteristics of the mailpiece, without regard to address placement. Then, determine length and height as follows:

- a. *Letter-Size Pieces (including Postcards)*. The following standard applies for these pieces:
 1. *Letter-Size*: For the purpose of determining mailability or machinability of a letter-size piece (see [1.1.3](#)), the *length* is the dimension parallel to the delivery address as read; the *height* is the dimension perpendicular to the length.
 2. *Postcard*: For the purpose of determining mailability of a First-Class Mail priced postcard-size piece (see [1.1.4](#)), the *length* is the dimension parallel to the delivery address as read; the *height* is the dimension perpendicular to the length.
- b. *Flat-Size Pieces*. The *length* of a flat-size mailpiece is the longest dimension. The *height* is the dimension perpendicular to the length.
- c. *Parcels*. The *length* is the longest dimension.
- d. *Customized MarketMail Pieces*. See [201.9.0](#).